👩‍🏫 Staff Guide · US History · Unit 2 The Heartland: Moving West (Level 3)

Level 3 = resource-room students who can work close to the gen ed lesson. No slide decks: students follow Ms. Stockmar's lesson and slides with Level 3 readings, guided notes and a quick check.

1. How the pieces line up

Gen ed lesson	Level 3 piece
Her readings and worksheets	Level 3 reading (5 short paragraphs) + check questions
Class notes	Level 3 guided notes + key
Unit quiz / test	Level 3 quick check + key
Review (Kahoot / Jeopardy)	1 Level 3 game on the class site: 10 questions + a matching round

2. Supports built in

- 🔊 Read aloud on the reading and notes pages (tap the button)
- Key terms listed at the top of the notes
- Short-answer lines sized for 1-2 sentences

3. What to grade

- Notes and reading checks: same points as her worksheets for that lesson
- Quick check: score, then scale to her test points
- Modified grading only as the IEP allows. Check with the case manager.

4. Who to ask

- Mr. Driver (SLE): changes and IEP questions.
- Facts we could not confirm say “check with Ms. Stockmar”.

🚧 Under construction (check with Ms. Stockmar)

- **Quiz cartoons**: Her quiz uses 3 political cartoons (“The Last Buffalo”, “The Reason of the Indian Outbreak”, the Indian Agent). We describe them in words and do not reprint them; the class copies are in her power point.

💗 Sensitive topic note

This unit includes massacres (Sand Creek 1864, Wounded Knee 1890) and the loss of Native land and the buffalo. We state the facts plainly with no images of violence. Some of her cartoons (“The Reason of the Indian Outbreak,” the Indian Agent, “Indian” cartoons) use racist caricatures of Native people; we do not show them. If the class views them, say first that the drawings are unfair stereotypes, and let students look at the message, not the drawing style. Native students may have family ties to these events; offer a pass on discussion.

🦬 The Heartland: Moving West: Guided Notes

US History · Unit 2 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Heartland Packet, American Progress, Life on the Plains, Heartland Quiz

Name: _____

Use the class slides and your reading. Key words:

Manifest Destiny | *Homestead Act* | *transcontinental railroad* | *sod house* | *Exodusters* | *reservation* | *Treaty of Fort Laramie* | *Little Bighorn* | *Dawes Act* | *Wounded Knee*

A. Heartland timeline (Heartland Packet)

1. Fill in the table.

Year	Event	Impact
1862		
1864		
1869		
1876		
1887		
1890		

B. Life on the Plains

2. Settlers built houses from _____ and burned buffalo _____ for fuel.

3. African Americans who moved to Kansas were called _____.

4. How did the railroad encourage settlement of the West?

_____

_____

C. Impact on Native nations

5. Analyze “American Progress” with BASIC: what is the artist's argument, and what does the painting leave out?

6. List one positive and two negative effects of westward expansion.

🦬 The Heartland: Moving West: Reading

US History · Unit 2 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Heartland Packet, American Progress, Life on the Plains, Heartland Quiz

Name: _____

Moving West: Progress for Whom?

After the Civil War ended in 1865, many Americans believed in Manifest Destiny: the idea that the United States was meant to spread across the continent. John Gast's 1872 painting “American Progress” shows this idea. A giant woman carries a schoolbook and telegraph wire west. Light follows her, and Native people and buffalo flee into the dark.

Government laws and new technology pushed settlement. The Homestead Act of 1862 gave 160 acres to any head of household who farmed the land for five years. In 1869 the Central Pacific and Union Pacific railroads met at Promontory Point, Utah. Chinese workers built much of the western line, doing the most dangerous jobs for lower pay.

Life on the Plains was hard. With few trees, families built sod houses and burned dried buffalo chips for heat. They faced isolation, blizzards, droughts and swarms of insects. Thousands of African Americans, called Exodusters, moved from the South to Kansas looking for land and safety. Cowboys, about a quarter of them Black and many of them Mexican vaqueros, drove cattle north to the railroads.

For Plains nations such as the Lakota, Cheyenne and Arapaho, expansion was a disaster. The buffalo, which gave them food, clothing and shelter, were hunted from millions to fewer than 1,000. In 1864 a Colorado militia attacked a peaceful Cheyenne and Arapaho camp at Sand Creek, killing more than 150 people. The 1868 Treaty of Fort Laramie promised the Lakota the Black Hills, but the US broke it after gold was found.

In 1876 Lakota and Cheyenne warriors led by Sitting Bull and Crazy Horse defeated Custer's 7th Cavalry at Little Bighorn. The army kept fighting, and Native nations were forced onto reservations. The Dawes Act of 1887 split reservations into small plots, and Native nations lost about two-thirds of their land. In 1890 soldiers killed about 300 Lakota at Wounded Knee, ending the major wars on the Plains.

Check your reading

1. What did Manifest Destiny mean to settlers, and what did it mean for Native nations?

2. Give two reasons settlement grew quickly after 1862.

3. Why was the loss of the buffalo so serious?

🦬 The Heartland: Moving West: Quick Check

US History · Unit 2 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Heartland Packet, American Progress, Life on the Plains, Heartland Quiz

Name: _____

Multiple choice and short answer. You may have it read aloud.

1. The Homestead Act offered…

A. Free train tickets west

B. Reservation land to Exodusters

C. 160 acres to families who farmed it for 5 years

2. Most of the western railroad was built by…

A. Chinese immigrant workers

B. Cowboys

C. Union soldiers only

3. The purpose of the Dawes Act was to…

A. Protect buffalo herds

B. Pay railroad companies

C. Break up tribal land into individual plots

4. Which event came last?

A. Wounded Knee

B. Sand Creek

C. Little Bighorn

5. What do the Sand Creek and Wounded Knee massacres show about westward expansion?

6. Why were cowboys more diverse than the movies show?

🦬 The Heartland: Moving West: Guided Notes · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 2 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Heartland Packet, American Progress, Life on the Plains, Heartland Quiz

Name: _____

Use the class slides and your reading. Key words:

Manifest Destiny | *Homestead Act* | *transcontinental railroad* | *sod house* | *Exodusters* | *reservation* | *Treaty of Fort Laramie* | *Little Bighorn* | *Dawes Act* | *Wounded Knee*

A. Heartland timeline (Heartland Packet)

1. Fill in the table.

Year	Event	Impact
1862	**Homestead Act**	**160 free acres brings settlers**
1864	**Sand Creek Massacre**	**150+ Cheyenne and Arapaho killed**
1869	**Transcontinental railroad finished**	**Fast travel; settlers and cattle move west**
1876	**Little Bighorn**	**Lakota/Cheyenne victory; army responds with force**
1887	**Dawes Act**	**Reservations broken up; land lost**
1890	**Wounded Knee**	**About 300 Lakota killed; end of Plains wars**

B. Life on the Plains

2. Settlers built houses from **sod** and burned buffalo **chips** for fuel.

3. African Americans who moved to Kansas were called **Exodusters**.

4. How did the railroad encourage settlement of the West?
Cheap, fast travel; it carried settlers, supplies and crops/cattle to markets.

C. Impact on Native nations

5. Analyze “American Progress” with BASIC: what is the artist's argument, and what does the painting leave out?
Argument: moving west brings light and progress. Left out: the Native view and the violence of taking land.

6. List one positive and two negative effects of westward expansion.
Positive: farms, ranches and towns grew. Negative: Native land and lives lost; buffalo nearly wiped out; Chinese workers mistreated.

🔑 *Key written by our team from Ms. Stockmar's worksheets and slides, please check.*

🦬 The Heartland: Moving West: Quick Check · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 2 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Heartland Packet, American Progress, Life on the Plains, Heartland Quiz

Name: _____

Multiple choice and short answer. You may have it read aloud.

1. The Homestead Act offered…

A. Free train tickets west	B. Reservation land to Exodusters	**C. 160 acres to families who farmed it for 5 years**

2. Most of the western railroad was built by…

A. Chinese immigrant workers	B. Cowboys	C. Union soldiers only

3. The purpose of the Dawes Act was to…

A. Protect buffalo herds	B. Pay railroad companies	**C. Break up tribal land into individual plots**

4. Which event came last?

A. Wounded Knee	B. Sand Creek	C. Little Bighorn

5. What do the Sand Creek and Wounded Knee massacres show about westward expansion?

A disregard for Native lives and culture; force was used to take land.

6. Why were cowboys more diverse than the movies show?

About a quarter were African American and many were Mexican vaqueros; ranching began in Mexico.

🔑 *Reworded from her 2019 Heartland Quiz and Heartland Packet, please check.*